“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 15

The Lord’s Paugaṇḍa Pastimes

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. In the fifteenth chapter the Lord studies grammar with Gaṅgādāsa Paṇḍita, becomes expert in the *Pañjī-ṭīkā* and forbids His mother to eat grains on Ekādaśī. He tells a story: Viśvarūpa, having taken *sannyāsa*, called Him to take *sannyāsa* too, but He did not listen and said He wished to serve His parents — and so Viśvarūpa sent Him back home. The departure of Purandara Miśra[1] from this world, the marriage to Lakṣmī-devī, daughter of Vallabhācārya, and other events are described in brief.

*By worshipping Gaura even the evil-minded gains a good mind — (*Hari-bhakti-vilāsa*, *vilāsa* 7, verse 1)*

কুমনাঃ সুমনস্ত্বং হি যাতি যস্য পদাব্জয়োঃ ।
সুমনোঽর্পণমাত্রেণ তং চৈতন্যপ্রভুং ভজে ॥ ১ ॥

ku-manāḥ su-manastvaṁ hi
the evil-minded good-mindedness indeed
yāti yasya padābjayoḥ
attains whose at the lotus feet
su-mano-’rpaṇa-mātreṇa
of a flower by the offering merely
taṁ caitanya-prabhuṁ bhaje
Him Lord Caitanya I worship

1 “I worship Lord Caitanya: by merely offering a flower (*sumanas*) at His lotus feet, even an evil-minded person becomes good-minded.” (Hari-bhakti-vilāsa 7.1)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One need only offer *sumanas* (jasmine flowers) at His lotus feet, and even a person of evil mind (*ku-manāḥ*) gains a good mind (*sumanas*)[2]. That Caitanya Prabhu I worship.

Anubhāṣya.

ku-manāḥ (one whose mind is absorbed in objects other than Kṛṣṇa) **yasya** (of Caitanya-deva) **padābjayoḥ** (at the lotus feet) **su-mano-'rpaṇa-mātreṇa** (merely by offering *sumanas*, flowers, or else one's own mind that is *su*, good, intent on serving Kṛṣṇa) **su-manastvaṁ** (a nature free of other desires, not covered by *jñāna*, karma and the like, and devoted to serving Kṛṣṇa, *kṛṣṇānuśīlana*) **hi** (certainly) **yāti** (attains), **taṁ caitanya-prabhum ahaṁ vande**.

জয় জয় শ্রীচৈতন্য জয় নিত্যানন্দ ।
জয়াদ্বৈতচন্দ্র, জয় গৌরভক্তবৃন্দ ॥ ২ ॥

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda
glory glory to Śrī Caitanya glory to Nityānanda
jayādvaitacandra, jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda
glory to Advaitacandra glory to Gaura’s devotees all

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

*Among the pastimes of the *paugaṇḍa* age, the pastime of study is the chief —*

পৌগণ্ড-লীলার সূত্র করিয়ে গণন ।
পৌগণ্ড-বয়সে প্রভুর মুখ্য অধ্যয়ন ॥ ৩ ॥

paugaṇḍa-līlāra sūtra kariye gaṇana
of the paugaṇḍa pastimes the sūtras I make enumeration
paugaṇḍa-vayase prabhura mukhya adhyayana
in the paugaṇḍa age the Lord’s chief study

3 I shall now list the *sūtras* of the *paugaṇḍa* pastimes. In His *paugaṇḍa* years the Lord's chief occupation was study.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Mukhya adhyayana: His chief activity was the pastime of study.

*The Lord's very extensive pastimes of the *paugaṇḍa* age —*

পৌগণ্ডলীলা চৈতন্যকৃষ্ণস্যাতিসুবিস্তৃতা ।
বিদ্যারম্ভমুখা পাণিগ্রহণান্তা মনোহরা ॥ ৪ ॥

paugaṇḍa-līlā caitanya-
the paugaṇḍa pastimes of Caitanya-
kṛṣṇasyāti-suvistṛtā
Kṛṣṇa very extensive
vidyārambha-mukhā pāṇi-
the beginning of learning as the start hand-
grahaṇāntā mano-harā
taking as the end enchanting

4 The *paugaṇḍa* pastimes of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa are very extensive and enchanting: they begin with the start of His learning and end with His taking a bride's hand.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The charming pastimes of the *paugaṇḍa* age (boyhood) of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, from the beginning of His schooling to His marriage, are very extensive.

Anubhāṣya.

caitanya-kṛṣṇasya (of Bhagavān Viśvambhara, whose form is non-different from Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa) **vidyārambha-mukhā** (those whose beginning is the start of schooling) **pāṇi-grahaṇāntā** (and whose end, conclusion, is His marriage) **mano-harā** (captivating all hearts) **paugaṇḍa-līlā** (*paugaṇḍa* is the period from the fifth year to the tenth; the pastimes in that period) **ati-suvistṛtā** (are very extensive).

Studying grammar with Paṇḍita Gaṅgādāsa —

গঙ্গাদাস পণ্ডিত-স্থানে পড়েন ব্যাকরণ ।
শ্রবণ-মাত্রে কণ্ঠে কৈল সূত্রবৃত্তিগণ ॥ ৫ ॥

gaṅgādāsa paṇḍita-sthāne paḍena vyākaraṇa
of Gaṅgādāsa Paṇḍita at the place studies grammar
śravaṇa-mātre kaṇṭhe kaila sūtra-vṛtti-gaṇa
on hearing only by heart made sūtras and glosses

5 He studied grammar with Gaṅgādāsa Paṇḍita and learned the *sūtras* and their glosses by heart on hearing them only once.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
First He received His elementary education from Viṣṇu and Sudarśana, and then He studied grammar with Gaṅgādāsa Paṇḍita.

Mastery within a short time —

অল্পকালে হৈলা পঞ্জী-টীকাতে প্রবীণ ।
চিরকালের পড়ুয়া জিনে হইয়া নবীন ॥ ৬ ॥

alpa-kāle hailā pañjī-ṭīkāte pravīṇa
in a short time became in the pañjī-ṭīkā expert
cira-kālera paḍuyā jine haiyā navīna
of long standing students defeats being new

6 In a short time He became expert in the *Pañjī-ṭīkā*; though a newcomer, He outdid students of long standing.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Pañjī-ṭīkā: there was a well-known commentary on grammar called the *Pañjī-ṭīkā*, and Mahāprabhu composed glosses (*ṭippanī*) on it.

অধ্যয়ন-লীলা প্রভুর দাস-বৃন্দাবন ।
'চৈতন্যমঙ্গলে' কৈল বিস্তারিত বর্ণন ॥ ৭ ॥

adhyayana-līlā prabhura dāsa-vṛndāvana
the pastimes of study the Lord's Vṛndāvana dāsa
'caitanya-maṅgale' kaila vistārita varṇana
in the Caitanya-maṅgala made detailed description

7 Vṛndāvana dāsa has described the Lord's pastimes of study in detail in the *Caitanya-maṅgala*.

Anubhāṣya.
See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapters 4, 6, 7, 8, 9 and 10.

এক দিন মাতার পদে করিয়া প্রণাম ।
প্রভু কহে, — মাতা, মোরে দেহ এক দান ॥ ৮ ॥

eka dina mātāra pade kariyā praṇāma
one day at the mother's feet making obeisance
prabhu kahe, — mātā, more deha eka dāna
the Lord says Mother to Me give one gift

8 One day, bowing at His mother's feet, the Lord said, "Mother, give Me one gift."

He leads Mother Śacī to keep the Ekādaśī vow —

মাতা বলে, — তাই দিব, যা তুমি মাগিবে ।
প্রভু কহে, — একাদশীতে অন্ন না খাইবে ॥ ৯ ॥

mātā bale, — tāi diba, yā tumi māgibe
the mother says that I will give what You will ask
prabhu kahe, — ekādaśīte anna nā khāibe
the Lord says on Ekādaśī grains not you shall eat

9 His mother said, "I will give whatever You ask." The Lord said, "Do not eat grains on Ekādaśī."

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Jīva Prabhu in the *Bhakti-sandarbha* (section 299): "In the *Skanda Purāṇa*: 'One who eats on Ekādaśī is a killer of his mother, a killer of his father, a killer of his brother and a killer of his guru; he falls from Viṣṇuloka.' Here fasting

(*nirāhāratva*) for Vaiṣṇavas means only giving up the *mahā-prasāda* grain (*anna*), since eating anything else is always forbidden to them. In the *Agni Purāṇa*: 'One should not eat on Ekādaśī; this vow is the great vow of the Vaiṣṇavas.' This shows, first of all, that it is obligatory even for a non-Vaiṣṇava."

Vaiṣṇavas never accept anything but *mahā-prasāda*, on any day or at any time. But on the day of Ekādaśī, giving up *mahā-prasāda* is precisely what is called "fasting" (*upavāsa*).

শচী কহে, — না খাইব, ভালই কহিলা ।
সেই হৈতে একাদশী করিতে লাগিলা ॥ ১০ ॥

śacī kahe, — nā khāiba, bhālai kahilā
Śacī says not I will eat well indeed You said
sei haite ekādaśī karite lāgilā
from that since Ekādaśī to observe began

10 Śacī said, "I will not eat them; You have spoken well." From then on she began to observe Ekādaśī.

A bride is sought for Viśvarūpa —

তবে মিশ্র বিশ্বরূপের দেখিয়া যৌবন ।
কন্যা মাগি' বিবাহ দিতে কৈল মন ॥ ১১ ॥

tabe miśra viśvarūpera dekhiyā yauvana
then Miśra Viśvarūpa's seeing youth
kanyā māgi' vivāha dite kaila mana
a girl seeking marriage to give made mind

11 Then Miśra, seeing that Viśvarūpa had reached youth, resolved to find a bride and arrange his marriage.

*Viśvarūpa accepts *sannyāsa* —*

বিশ্বরূপ শুনি' ঘর ছাড়ি' পলাইলা ।
সন্ন্যাস করিয়া তীর্থ করিবারে গেলা ॥ ১২ ॥

viśvarūpa śuni' ghara chāḍi' palāilā
Viśvarūpa hearing home leaving fled
sannyāsa kariyā tīrtha karibāre gelā
sannyāsa taking pilgrimage to make went

12 Hearing of it, Viśvarūpa left home and fled; he took *sannyāsa* and went on pilgrimage.

The grief of Śacī and Miśra; the Lord consoles them —

শুনি' শচী-মিশ্রের দুঃখী হৈল মন ।
তবে প্রভু মাতা-পিতার কৈল আশ্বাসন ॥ ১৩ ॥

śuni' śacī-miśrera duḥkhī haila mana
hearing of Śacī and Miśra sorrowful became the minds
tabe prabhu mātā-pitāra kaila āśvāsana
then the Lord mother and father made consolation

13 Hearing this, Śacī and Miśra were grief-stricken, and the Lord consoled His mother and father:

*When a son takes *sannyāsa* to serve Kṛṣṇa, the families of his mother and father are delivered —*

ভাল হৈল, — বিশ্বরূপ সন্ন্যাস করিল ।
পিতৃকূল মাতৃকূল, — দুই উদ্ধারিল ॥ ১৪ ॥

bhāla haila, — viśvarūpa sannyāsa karila
good it has become Viśvarūpa sannyāsa has taken
pitṛkūla mātṛkūla, — dui uddhārila
the father's family the mother's family both has delivered

14 "It is good that Viśvarūpa has taken *sannyāsa*: he has delivered both his father's family and his mother's.

Consoled by the Lord, His parents are content —

আমি ত' করিব তোমা' দুঁহার সেবন ।
শুনিয়া সন্তুষ্ট হৈল পিতামাতার মন ॥ ১৫ ॥

āmi ta' kariba tomā' duṅhāra sevana
I indeed will do you both's service
śuniyā santuṣṭa haila pitāmātāra mana
hearing satisfied became of father and mother the minds

15 I will serve you both." Hearing this, His father and mother were comforted.

The Lord loses consciousness —

একদিন নৈবেদ্য-তাম্বূল খাইয়া ।
ভূমিতে পড়িলা প্রভু অচেতন হঞা ॥ ১৬ ॥

ekadina naivedya-tāmbūla khāiyā
one day offered betel eating
bhūmite paḍilā prabhu acetana hañā
on the ground fell the Lord unconscious becoming

16 One day, after chewing betel that had been offered to the Deity, the Lord fell to the ground unconscious.

*The meeting with Viśvarūpa and their conversation about the Lord's *sannyāsa* —*

আস্তে-ব্যস্তে পিতা-মাতা মুখে দিল পানি ।
সুস্থ হঞা কহে প্রভু অপূর্ব্ব কাহিনী ॥ ১৭ ॥

āste-vyaste pitā-mātā mukhe dila pāni
hastily father and mother on the face gave water
sustha hañā kahe prabhu apūrva kāhinī
well becoming says the Lord extraordinary story

17 His father and mother hastily sprinkled water on His face, and when He came to, the Lord told them an extraordinary story:

এথা হৈতে বিশ্বরূপ মোরে লঞা গেলা ।
সন্ন্যাস করহ তুমি' আমারে কহিলা ॥ ১৮ ॥

ethā haite viśvarūpa more lañā gelā
here from Viśvarūpa Me taking went
sannyāsa karaha tumi' āmāre kahilā
sannyāsa take You to Me said

18 "Viśvarūpa took Me away from here and told Me, 'Take *sannyāsa*.'

আমি কহি, — আমার অনাথ পিতা-মাতা ।
আমি বালক, — সন্ন্যাসের কিবা জানি কথা ॥ ১৯ ॥

āmi kahi, — āmāra anātha pitā-mātā
I said My helpless father and mother
āmi bālaka, — sannyāsera kibā jāni kathā
I am a boy of sannyāsa what know I the matter

19 I said, 'My father and mother are helpless, and I am only a boy—what do I know of *sannyāsa*?

গৃহস্থ হইয়া করি পিতৃ-মাতৃ-সেবন ।
ইহাতে সন্তুষ্ট হবেন লক্ষ্মী-নারায়ণ ॥ ২০ ॥

gṛhastha haiyā kari pitṛ-mātṛ-sevana
a householder becoming I shall do to father and mother service
ihāte santuṣṭa habena lakṣmī-nārāyaṇa
by this pleased will be Lakṣmī-Nārāyaṇa

20 As a householder I shall serve My father and mother; that will please Lakṣmī-Nārāyaṇa.'

তবে বিশ্বরূপ ইঁহা পাঠাইল মোরে ।
মাতাকে কহিলা কোটি কোটি নমস্কারে ॥ ২১ ॥

tabe viśvarūpa iṅhā pāṭhāila more
then Viśvarūpa here sent Me
mātāke kahilā koṭi koṭi namaskāre
to the mother told millions and millions of obeisances

21 Then Viśvarūpa sent Me back here and asked Me to convey millions upon millions of obeisances to Mother."

এইমত নানা লীলা করে গৌরহরি ।
কি কারণে লীলা, — ইহা বুঝিতে না পারি ॥ ২২ ॥

ei mata nānā līlā kare gaurahari
in this way various pastimes does Gaurahari
ki kāraṇe līlā, — ihā bujhite nā pāri
for what reason the pastimes this to understand not I can

22 In this way Gaurahari performed various pastimes; why He performed them, I cannot understand.

Miśra's departure —

কতদিন রহি' মিশ্র গেলা পরলোক ।
মাতা-পুত্র দুঁহার বাড়িল হৃদি শোক ॥ ২৩ ॥

kata dina rahi' miśra gelā para-loka
some days remaining Miśra went to the other world
mātā-putra duṅhāra bāḍila hṛdi śoka
mother and son of both increased in the heart grief

23 After some days Miśra departed for the other world, and grief welled up in the hearts of both mother and son.

Anubhāṣya.
The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Ādi, Chapter 8): "Some days passed in this way, and then the eternally perfect body of the best of Miśras departed from this world. At Miśra's departure the Lord wept bitterly, as the best of the Raghus wept at Daśaratha's departure. All this is full of the *rasa* of sorrow; to tell it in detail is painful, so I have told it briefly."

The Lord performs the rites for His father —

বন্ধু-বান্ধব আসি' দুঁহা প্রবোধিল ।
পিতৃক্রিয়া বিধিমতে ঈশ্বর করিল ॥ ২৪ ॥

bandhu-bāndhava āsi' duṅhā prabodhila
friends and relatives coming the two consoled
pitṛ-kriyā vidhi-mate īśvara karila
the rites for the father according to the rules the Lord performed

24 Friends and relatives came and consoled them both, and the Lord performed the rites for His father according to scriptural rule.

The wish to enact the pastimes of household life —

কত দিনে প্রভু চিত্তে করিলা চিন্তন ।
গৃহস্থ হইলাম, এবে চাহি গৃহধর্ম্ম ॥ ২৫ ॥

kata dine prabhu citte karilā cintana
after some days the Lord in the mind made reflection
gṛhastha hailāma, ebe cāhi gṛha-dharma
a householder I have become now I want household dharma

25 Some days later the Lord reflected, "I have remained a householder; now I should follow the duties of household life.

The wife is the home —

গৃহিণী বিনা গৃহধর্ম্ম না হয় শোভন ।
এত চিন্তি, বিবাহ করিতে হৈল মন ॥ ২৬ ॥

gṛhiṇī vinā gṛha-dharma nā haya śobhana
a housewife without household dharma not is beautiful
eta cinti, vivāha karite haila mana
so thinking marriage to make became mind

26 Without a wife, household life is not graceful." Thinking this, He resolved to marry.

*[Words of *smṛti* (of the Lord?)]*

ন গৃহং গৃহমিত্যাহুর্গৃহিণী গৃহমুচ্যতে ৷
তয়া হি সহিতঃ সর্ব্বান্ পুরুষার্থান্ সমশ্নুতে ॥ ২৭ ॥

na gṛhaṁ gṛham ity āhur
not the house a home so they say
gṛhiṇī gṛham ucyate
the housewife the home is called
tayā hi sahitaḥ sarvān
with her indeed together all
puruṣārthān samaśnute
the goals of life one attains

27 "It is not the house that is called the home; the wife is called the home. Together with her one attains all the goals of life."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
It is not the house that is called "home"; the mistress of the house is called "home." Together with her one will enjoy all the goals of human life (*puruṣārthas*).

Thus ends the fifteenth chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

Anubhāṣya.
gṛham (the dwelling building) **gṛhaṁ na**, **gṛhiṇī** (the mistress who presides over the house, one's partner in *dharma*) **eva gṛham ucyate**. **tayā** (with the wife) **sahitaḥ** (united) (a man) **sarvān puruṣārthān** (all the four goals — *dharma*, *artha*, *kāma*, *mokṣa* and the rest) **samaśnute** (attains). See the *Mahābhārata*, *Śānti-parva*, Chapter 144, verse 6.

The meeting with Lakṣmī-devī —

দৈবে এক দিন প্রভু পড়িয়া আসিতে ৷
বল্লভাচার্য্যের কন্যা দেখে গঙ্গা-পথে ॥ ২৮ ॥

daive eka dina prabhu paḍiyā āsite
by providence one day the Lord having studied coming back
vallabhācāryera kanyā dekhe gaṅgā-pathe
Vallabhācārya's daughter sees on the path to the Gaṅgā

28 One day, by providence, as the Lord was returning from His studies, He saw Vallabhācārya's daughter on the path to the Gaṅgā.

Vanamālī Paṇḍita as matchmaker —

পূর্ব্বসিদ্ধ ভাব দুঁহার উদয় করিলা ।
দৈবে বনমালী ঘটক শচী-স্থানে আইলা ॥ ২৯ ॥

pūrva-siddha bhāva duṅhāra udaya karilā
eternally perfect feeling of the two arising made
daive vanamālī ghaṭaka śacī-sthāne āilā
by providence Vanamālī the matchmaker to Śacī's place came

29 Their eternally perfect love awakened in them both, and by providence the matchmaker Vanamālī came to Śacī.

Anubhāṣya.
Vanamālī the matchmaker (*ghaṭaka*) was a brāhmaṇa living in Navadvīpa. He arranged Mahāprabhu's marriage. *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (49): "Viśvāmitra, who was the matchmaker at Śrī Rāma's wedding, and the brāhmaṇa whom Rukmiṇī sent to Śrī Keśava — both are now this Vanamālī, who by his deed attained the title of ācārya."

The match and the Lord's marriage to Lakṣmī-devī —

শচীর ইঙ্গিতে সম্বন্ধ করিল ঘটন ।
লক্ষ্মীকে বিবাহ কৈল শচীর নন্দন ॥ ৩০ ॥

śacīra iṅgite sambandha karila ghaṭana
by Śacī's hint the match made arranged
lakṣmīke vivāha kaila śacīra nandana
Lakṣmī married Śacī's son

30 At a hint from Śacī he arranged the match, and the son of Śacī married Lakṣmī.

*The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* describes the *paugaṇḍa* pastimes in detail —*

বিস্তারিয়া বর্ণিলা তাহা বৃন্দাবন-দাস ।
এই ত' পৌগণ্ড-লীলার সূত্র প্রকাশ ॥ ৩১ ॥

vistāriyā varṇilā tāhā vṛndāvana-dāsa
in detail has described that Vṛndāvana dāsa
ei ta' paugaṇḍa-līlāra sūtra prakāśa
this indeed of the paugaṇḍa pastimes the sūtra manifestation

31 Vṛndāvana dāsa has described this in detail. Here only the *sūtra* of the *paugaṇḍa* pastimes is set forth.

Anubhāṣya.

See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapter 10. The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Ādi, Chapter 8) describes in more detail the sacred-thread ceremony (*upanayana*) and the Lord's gift of gold to His mother.

Thus ends the fifteenth chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

পৌগণ্ড-লীলায় লীলা বহু ত' প্রকার ।
বৃন্দাবন-দাস ইঁহা করিয়াছেন বিস্তার ॥ ৩২ ॥

paugaṇḍa-līlāya līlā bahu ta' prakāra
in the paugaṇḍa pastimes pastimes many indeed kinds
vṛndāvana-dāsa iṅhā kariyāchena vistāra
Vṛndāvana dāsa this has made in detail

32 There are many kinds of pastimes in the *paugaṇḍa* period, and Vṛndāvana dāsa has described them in detail.

অতএব দিঙ্মাত্র ইঁহা দেখাইল ।
'চৈতন্যমঙ্গলে' সর্ব্বলোকে খ্যাতি হৈল ॥ ৩৩ ॥

ataeva diṅmātra iṅhā dekhāila
therefore a mere indication here I have shown
'caitanya-maṅgale' sarva-loke khyāti haila
in the Caitanya-maṅgala among all people fame has arisen

33 Therefore I have given only a glimpse of them here; through the *Caitanya-maṅgala* they have become famous among all people.

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ৩৪ ॥

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Raghunātha whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
Caitanya-caritāmṛta tells Kṛṣṇadāsa

34 Hoping for the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Raghunātha, Kṛṣṇadāsa tells the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. Purandara Miśra is another name of Jagannātha Miśra, the Lord's father. ↩
2. A play on words: *sumanas* means both “flower” and “good mind.” ↩